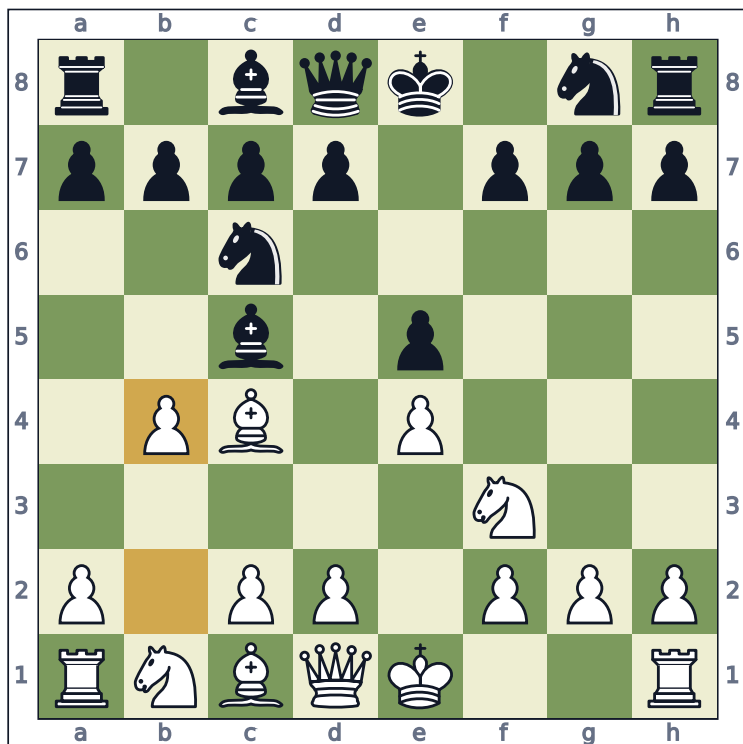


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Italian Game

ECO C51 | 29 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has already conceded the easier game and must know the compensation or plan.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

-0.45 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C51 covers Italian Game. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Italian Game: Evans Gambit.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C51 line

This section preserves all 29 names and defining routes assigned to C51 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Italian Game: Evans Gambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4

002 Italian Game: Evans Gambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3 Bg4

003 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Accepted
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4

004 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6

005 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. a4

006 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Cordel Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. Bb2

007 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Hicken Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. b5 Na5 6. Nxe5 Qg5 7. Qf3 Qxe5 8. Qxf7+ Kd8 9. Bb2

008 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Hirschbach Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. b5 Na5 6. Nxe5 Qg5

009 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Lange Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. b5 Na5 6. Nxe5 Nh6

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010 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Pavlov Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. b5 Na5 6. Nxe5 Nh6 7. d4 d6 8. Bxh6 dxe5 9. Bxg7 Rg8 10. Bxf7+ Kxf7 11. Bxe5 Qg5 12. Nd2

011 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Showalter Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. a4 a6 6. Nc3

012 Italian Game: Evans Gambit Declined, Vasquez Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bb6 5. b5 Na5 6. Nxe5 Qg5 7. Bxf7+ Ke7 8. Qh5

013 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Anderssen Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Be7

014 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Anderssen Variation, Cordel Line

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Be7 6. d4 Na5

015 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Fontaine Countergambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 b5

016 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Fraser Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3 Bg4 10. Qa4

017 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Fraser-Mortimer Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3 Bg4 10. Qa4 Bd7 11. Qb3 Na5 12. Bxf7+ Kf8 13. Qc2

018 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Göring Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3 Na5 10. Bg5

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019 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Harding Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. cxd4 Bb4+ 8. Bd2

020 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Hein Countergambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 d5

021 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Mayet Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bf8

022 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, McDonnell Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5

023 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, McDonnell Defense, Main Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6

024 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Morphy Attack
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3

025 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Mortimer-Evans Gambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3 Bg4 10. Qa4 Bd7 11. Qb3 Na5 12. Bxf7+ Kf8 13. Qc2 Kxf7

026 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Paulsen Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. d5 Na5 10. Bb2 Ne7

027 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Steinitz Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. Nc3 Na5 10. Bg5 f6 11. Be3

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028 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Stone-Ware Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bd6

029 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Ulvestad Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Bc5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. cxd4 Bb6 9. d5 Na5 10. Bb2